O.P. JINDAL GLOBAL

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MARKETING MANAGEMENT

End-term Exam Assignment

1. Segmentation, Targeting, and Positioning Strategy for *"Seed & Soil"*

To launch "Seed & Soil," an organic food brand, I will follow a structured STP approach.

Segmentation: I will target the market based on demographics, psychographics, and behavior. Demographically, the organization would target health-conscious consumers in the age group of 25-45, who are generally professionals or young families and have moderate to high income. From a psychographic point of view, these consumers are committed to sustainability, wellness and ethical consumption. Behaviorally, they are predisposed to making organic or eco choices and paying a premium for quality. Smith and Paladino (2010) highlights the importance of lifestyle alignment and value-driven segmentation in the organic market, the market is not just driven by physical benefits it is one that demands we provide meaning and connection on their terms. Smith and Paladino (2010) also found that consumers in the organic market are highly influenced by personal values, especially regarding health, ethics, and environmental concern, rather than just product features. This indicates the importance of aligning brand messaging with consumer beliefs for effective segmentation.

Targeting: I will employ a targeting policy with heterogeneity. And there will be a portion of young urban professionals for whom convenience won't be worth the trade-off in health. Another will be eco-conscious families with kids, who care about safety and purity in food. Both groups are united by their values yet have divergent lifestyles and shopping habits that we can address by designing our message and product mix to fit them.

Positioning: "Seed & Soil" as a brand will be built on clean, ethical farming and transparency. Our Positioning statement will be: ***"Organic food that nourishes you and the planet."*** We'll showcase our farm-to-shelf traceability, plastic-free packaging and community partnerships. Trust and authenticity are high on the list of purchase drivers in organic segments as Kumar and Ghodeswar (2015) substantiate. We will be able to build trust by promoting certifications, farm stories and the environmental impact we are making, to make sure the customer can perceive us as not only premium quality; but also, the one that offers the best product as we are committed to doing the right thing for our customers and our environment.

2. How Marketing Has Changed in the Digital World

Marketing has undergone profound change in this digital age, transcending from one way communication between brand and consumer to a direct, two-way personal dialogue. Previously marketers' traditional approach was broadcasting messages over TV, print, or radio in hopes consumers would absorb and act forever. However, in this digital age, we have conversations in real time, personalized campaigns that offer instant results. Now, brands communicate with customers directly on websites, apps, social media and emails.

Perhaps at the top of that list is the increased amount of data-driven decision making happening right now. Businesses use customer data for everything from predicting behavior to segmenting audiences with increasing precision to customizing content. For instance, an e-commerce site uses browsing history to recommend products, increasing satisfaction and sales. This data-rich environment provides continuously testable and optimized improving environment for brands and creating a highly responsive campaign (Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick, 2019). They say that personalization and interactivity have replaced old "spray and pray" methods of advertising.

Plus, content marketing, influencer partnerships and SEO are now at the heart of any contemporary marketing approach. Today's consumers are looking for more than just a product — educational blog articles, entertaining videos and social engagement play a role in their purchasing choices. There has never been a more powerful focus on trust-building and authenticity, particularly among the younger, digital-native consumers.

Then there's the whole issue of micro-targeting, which social media allows, where brands can share a message with a very precise audience. Now that marketing has been

democratized, small brands can be powerhouses if they are savvier in using digital tools. The digital landscape has not only grown the marketer's "toolkit" but also changed in essence how brands develop a relationship and trust with consumers.

3. Toothpaste vs. Laptop: Buyer Decision Model

The five common stages in a typical buyer decision model, when people go through deciding to buy anything are: need recognition, information search, evaluation of alternatives, purchase decision, and post-purchase actions. While the process is applicable to any product, the level of analysis depends on what type of product. The comparison of toothpaste and laptops exemplifies this nicely.

Most people buy toothpaste on an automatic pilot mode, which means we overlook offers that would save us money. Toothpaste is often needed on a regular basis, but the decision is usually based on brand recognition, price, or a personal preference for a version like whitening or herbal. Not too many people spend much time researching toothpaste before buying. The stages of search for information and evaluation are fast or simply not performed at all. Kotler et al. (2019) note that the act of purchasing behavior on these is habitual--characterized by low consumer involvement and with minimal brand differences perception. Even post-purchase behavior is simple: satisfaction leads to repeat purchases, while dissatisfaction may prompt switching brands.

In contrast when it comes to buying a laptop, there is high involvement, and consumers tend to spend more time deciding which to buy. The buyer identifies a need that's complex, for example education, productivity apps, official work or gaming, and then researches information online, reviews, consultations with peers, comparisons of brands and features, etc. Here the vetting process is strict, factoring in specs, warranty and after-sales service. The buying decision is often a big one - and may be part of financial planning. After purchase, people also dedicate

time to learning about the system and decide if the product met all their expectations and was this purchase worth buying.

The distinction between the two is level of involvement. A toothpaste is low-risk, affordable and something you buy on autopilot. However, for laptops, it's an expensive, high-stakes, and utility-dominant purchase; one that requires a great deal of thought.

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